Trust in Bangladesh's Second-Hand Online Market: A Market Analysis of Bikroy.com and Its Alternatives

Supplementary Report to the TrustBazaar Project Proposal

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Executive summary. Bikroy.com has been Bangladesh's largest online classifieds platform since 2012, and Facebook Marketplace and buy-and-sell groups carry much of the remaining person-to-person resale. This report examines why these established platforms remain exposed to fraud, and whether a new platform built around transaction protection could persuade users to move. Using news reports, police cases, company statements, platform terms, third-party traffic estimates and regulatory records, it finds that Bikroy's trust problem has existed since its own 2014 audit found one ad in three not genuine; that its market position and ownership have weakened, ending in its sale to Jiji in 2026; and that every documented scam occurs at the payment, handover or dispute stage, which neither Bikroy nor Facebook controls. Escrow, which Bangladesh Bank made mandatory for e-commerce in 2021, has never reached person-to-person resale. No existing platform combines resale between individuals with transaction protection. The report maps each identified loophole to TrustBazaar's design and concludes that users are most likely to adopt it first for high-value deals, where losing money to a stranger is most costly, rather than abandoning existing platforms outright.

1 Purpose, Scope and Method

Purpose. TrustBazaar is a proposed web platform for buying and selling used goods between individuals in Bangladesh, built around identity verification, escrow-held payment, a fair auction mechanism and coordinated delivery [21]. A new platform of this kind enters a market in which Bikroy.com has operated since 2012 and Facebook is used by most of the country's internet users. This report studies that market to answer one question: what would convince users to move from platforms they have used for years to a new one? It is a supplementary analysis to the project proposal, not a research paper, and is intended to provide the evidence behind the proposal's problem statement.

Scope. The analysis covers person-to-person resale of used goods in Bangladesh. It focuses on Bikroy.com as the market leader, compares it with Facebook Marketplace and buy-and-sell groups and with Daraz, and briefly examines the trade in digital goods such as game accounts and event tickets. Business-to-consumer sales of new goods are considered only as a point of comparison.

Method and sources. The report draws only on published or publicly accessible sources: national newspapers and police case reports; company statements, interviews and platform terms; regulatory announcements; app-store and review-site ratings; and third-party web-traffic estimates (Similarweb, Semrush). Every figure is attributed to its source. Where sources disagree, measure

different things, or where evidence is missing, the report says so. No primary survey of users was conducted; this is noted as a limitation in Section 6.

Structure. Section 2 traces Bikroy's history and present state. Section 3 examines users' experience and documented scams, and identifies six loopholes. Section 4 maps each loophole to TrustBazaar's design. Section 5 compares all the available platforms, and Section 6 draws the conclusions on user adoption.

2 Bikroy.com: Market History, Present State, and Decline

This section establishes how Bikroy started, how dominant it became, where it stands in 2026, and what has gone wrong. Every number below is taken from a published source listed in the references; where sources disagree or measure different things, we say so. Figure 1 summarises the full history.

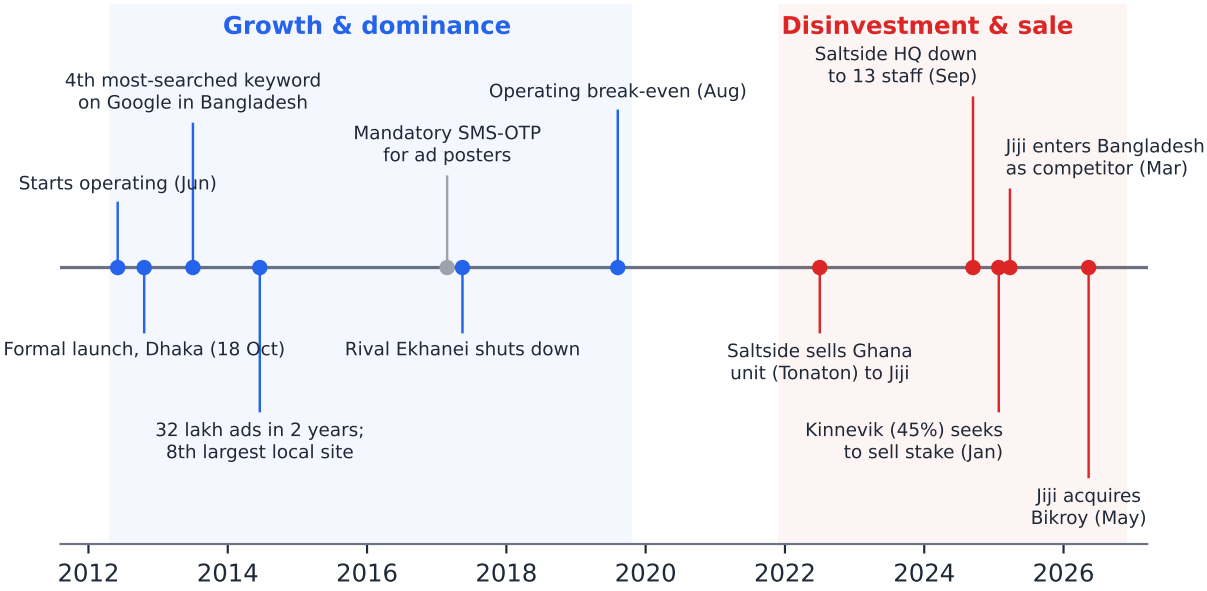


Figure 1: Timeline of Bikroy.com, 2012–2026. Blue: growth milestones; red: events in the decline of its parent company and its eventual sale; grey: anti-fraud measures. Sources: [1, 2, 6, 5, 9, 10, 11].

2.1 Launch and rapid growth (2012–2014)

Bikroy began operating in June 2012 and was formally launched at a press conference in Dhaka on 18 October 2012. The Daily Star described it at the time as the country's first bilingual (Bangla and English) classified website [1]. It was owned by Saltside Technologies, a Swedish company that also ran classifieds sites in Ghana (Tonaton) and Sri Lanka (ikman) [9].

Growth in the first two years was very fast (Figure 2). Bikroy received 26,000 advertisements in its first three months (June–August 2012), and 8.27 lakh (827,000) in March–May 2014 alone, an increase of roughly 32 times. By June 2014 it had received more than 32 lakh ads in total and was handling over 9,000 new ads per day, compared with about 3,000 a year earlier [2]. In the same period it became, by Alexa ranking, the 8th largest local website in Bangladesh [2], and in 2013 "Bikroy.com" was the 4th most-searched keyword on Google in Bangladesh [1]. In September 2014 the company stated that it received more than 2 million unique visitors per month [3].

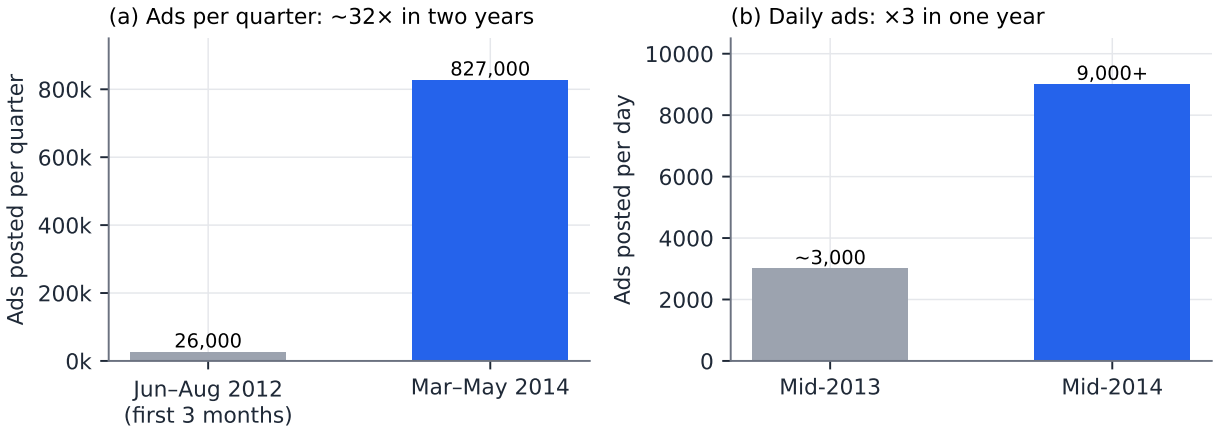


Figure 2: Bikroy's early growth. (a) Ads posted per quarter in the first quarter of operation and in March–May 2014. (b) Ads posted per day, mid-2013 vs. mid-2014. Source: Banglanews24 [2].

Fraud was present from the start. Rapid growth came with a trust problem that Bikroy itself acknowledged. In September 2014, Bikroy's marketing manager told the Crime Reporters Association of Bangladesh that in a random sample of 500 ads, only 330 (66%) were genuine; some advertisers did not respond when their listed numbers were called (Figure 3). She added that fake sellers typically priced items below market and, in many cases, lured buyers to remote locations and robbed them. Bikroy's investigation team removed more than 750 fake ads in August 2014 alone [4].

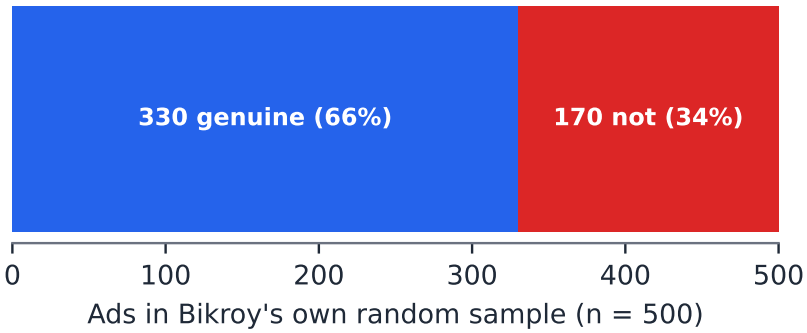


Figure 3: Result of Bikroy's own 2014 audit of 500 randomly sampled ads: one in three was not genuine. Source: Dhaka Tribune [4].

Note that the audit measured *ads*, not victims: the 170 non-genuine ads in the sample tell us how much of the catalogue could not be trusted, but Bikroy did not publish how many buyers had actually lost money to them.

What Bikroy did about it. Bikroy did respond, but every measure it took was aimed at cleaning up *listings*, not at protecting or compensating the people who *transacted* through them (Table 1).

Table 1: Bikroy's documented responses to fraud, 2014–2026, and whether each one protects money in a transaction or helps a victim recover a loss.

When	Measure	Protects payment?	Helps victims recover?
Aug 2014	Internal investigation team; 750+ fake ads removed in one month; press awareness event with crime reporters [4]	No	No
2016	"Buy Now": Bikroy-coordinated delivery with cash on delivery after inspection, for selected listings [6, 8]	Partly	No
Feb 2017	Mandatory SMS one-time-password for new ad posters; ban on replica and clone products [6]	No	No
Ongoing	Ads reviewed before publication [11]; full records kept on paying members, cited by Bikroy during a police case [16]	No	Indirectly
2026	Safety-tips page: check seller feedback, avoid prepayment, inspect before paying; no escrow, payment protection or refund process [19]	No	No

No compensation, by design. We found no public record of Bikroy refunding or compensating any fraud victim, at any point from 2012 to 2026. This is not an oversight but the platform's stated policy. Bikroy's current Terms and Conditions (operated by Bikroy Marketplace Ltd., last updated 17 April 2026) state that the platform is not a party to transactions between users, accept no responsibility for loss or damage arising from user interactions, place the duty of due diligence on the user, and cap Bikroy's total liability at the lesser of the fees the user paid in the previous six months or BDT 6,700. Fees paid for promotion are non-refundable [18]. A buyer who sends a 50,000-taka advance to a fake seller therefore has no recourse against Bikroy; the only route is a police case against the scammer, as in the Muktagacha case, where Bikroy's public role was limited to pointing to the records it keeps on paying members and checking whether any of its own staff or courier employees were involved [16].

The audit was never repeated publicly. The 2014 figure of 66% genuine ads is the only fraud-rate measurement Bikroy appears to have ever published. We found no later audit, no annual trust-and-safety report, and no statement of how the genuine-ad rate changed after the 2017 measures. Bikroy's later public statements on fraud are general assurances, such as that ads are reviewed before publication [11], rather than measured results, while fraud on the platform continues to surface in police reporting of individual scams (Section 2.6). Without a published follow-up, there is no evidence that the problem identified in 2014 was ever measured as solved.

2.2 Market dominance (2015–2019)

Bikroy did not win its market by out-competing rivals on trust; it won by outlasting them. Ekhanei (formerly CellBazaar, owned by Telenor, Schibsted and Naspers, and merged with OLX Bangladesh in 2015) shut down on 17 May 2017, with its owners stating that they had been unable to build a sustainable, profitable business [5]. With its main rival gone, Bikroy became the clear market leader.

During this period Bikroy added a membership programme for small businesses (2016), a "Buy Now" service with partner couriers and cash-on-delivery after inspection, and, in February 2017, mandatory SMS one-time-password verification for new ad posters together with a ban on replica products [1, 8, 6]. Future Startup noted at the time that there was "a widespread allegation against Bikroy for allowing fake products" [6]. In August 2019 Bikroy reached operating break-even for the first time [1, 9].

Saltside's last institutional funding round, a $40 million Series B from Kinnevik, Hillhouse Capital and Brummer & Partners, closed in January 2015 [9]. As Figure 9 shows, no new capital followed for more than a decade.

2.3 Bikroy in 2026: still large, but losing position

Bikroy has not collapsed. At the time of its sale in May 2026 it reported over 10 million app downloads, about 400,000 monthly buyers, more than 100,000 monthly sellers, roughly 3 million unique monthly visitors, 420 employees, and more than $3 billion in annual gross merchandise value (GMV) [9]. That GMV is concentrated in high-value categories, mainly vehicles and real estate [9]. Table 2 compares its position then and now.

Table 2: Bikroy.com then and now. Third-party traffic figures are estimates and are not directly comparable with company-reported figures.

Indicator	2013–2014	2025–2026
Rank in Bangladesh	8th largest local site (Alexa) [2]	#67 (Similarweb, Sep 2026) [12]; #104 (Semrush, Aug 2026) [13]
Monthly audience	2.0M+ unique visitors (company, 2014) [3]	∼3M unique visitors (company, 2026) [9]; 3.3M total visits in the last three months (Similarweb, Jul–Sep 2026) [12]
Traffic trend	Ads ×32 in two years [2]	−18.93% MoM (Dec 2025, Semrush) [14]; −12.78% MoM (Sep 2026, Similarweb) [12]
Owner	Saltside Technologies, actively funded ($40M, Jan 2015) [9]	Jiji (Nigeria), acquired May 2026 [11]
User trust	Only 66% of sampled ads genuine [4]	Trustpilot score 2.0/5 (13 reviews) [15]

Ranking. Bikroy has fallen from a top-ten local website in 2014 to between #67 and #104 among all websites visited in Bangladesh in 2026, depending on the analytics provider (Figure 4). The two measures are not identical (Alexa's 2014 figure ranked *local* sites, whereas today's figures rank all sites, including Google, Facebook and YouTube), so the size of the fall should not be overstated, but the direction is clear.

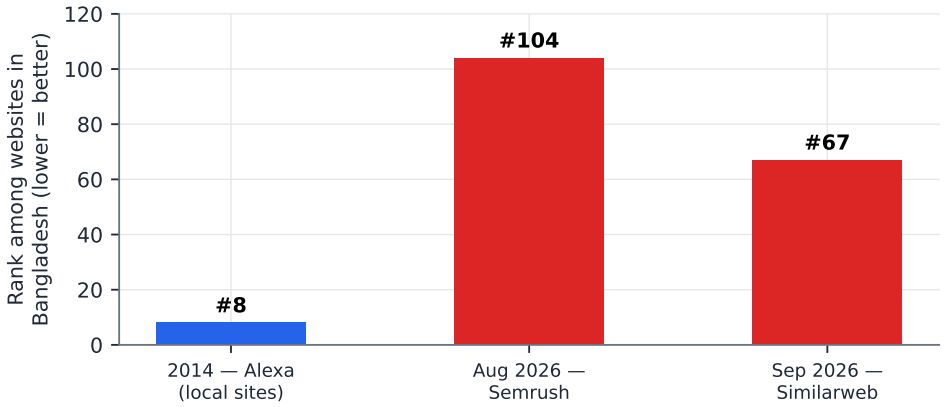


Figure 4: Bikroy's website rank in Bangladesh, 2014 vs. 2026. The 2014 figure is Alexa's ranking among local websites; the 2026 figures rank all websites. Sources: [2, 13, 12].

Recent traffic. Both independent analytics providers we checked report month-on-month declines: Semrush estimated 1.35 million visits in December 2025, down 18.93% from November [14], and Similarweb reported a 12.78% month-on-month fall for September 2026, with Bikroy's global

rank slipping from #10,746 to #12,370 over three months [12] (Figure 5). Single-month changes can reflect seasonality, so these figures indicate softening rather than proof of a long-term trend.

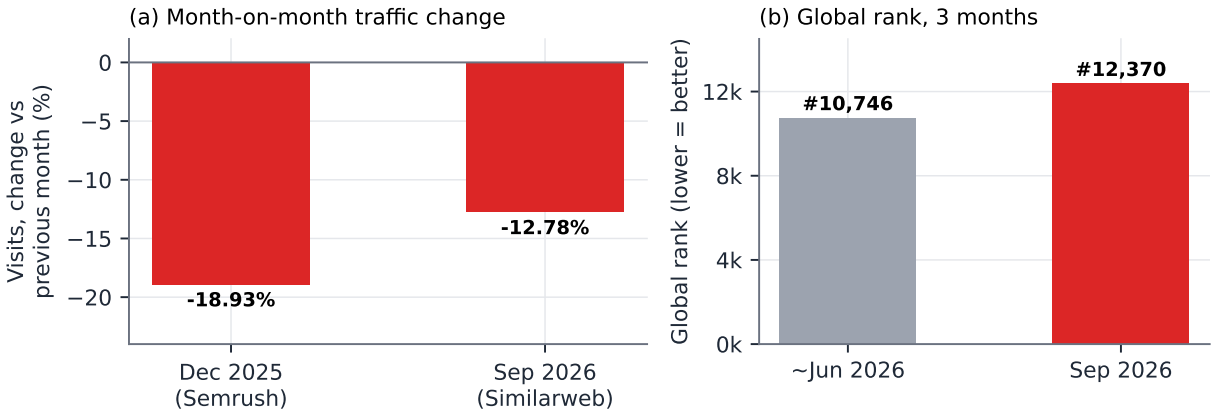


Figure 5: Recent traffic signals. (a) Month-on-month change in visits reported by Semrush (December 2025) and Similarweb (September 2026). (b) Similarweb global rank at the start and end of the three months to September 2026. Sources: [14, 12].

2.4 What Bikroy sells and how many people use it

Most ads are everyday used goods. A snapshot of Bikroy's category pages on 7 October 2026 counted 296,743 live ads on the site as a whole; the 17 top-level categories sum to 300,635, a difference of about 1% that reflects ads being added and removed while the pages were read [40]. Figure 6 shows the breakdown. Phones and tablets (85,553 ads, 28.5%) and electronics (57,170, 19.0%) together make up almost half of all listings, followed by home, furniture and appliances (32,892, 10.9%). Vehicles (29,987, 10.0%) and property (14,242, 4.7%) together account for only about 15% of ads.

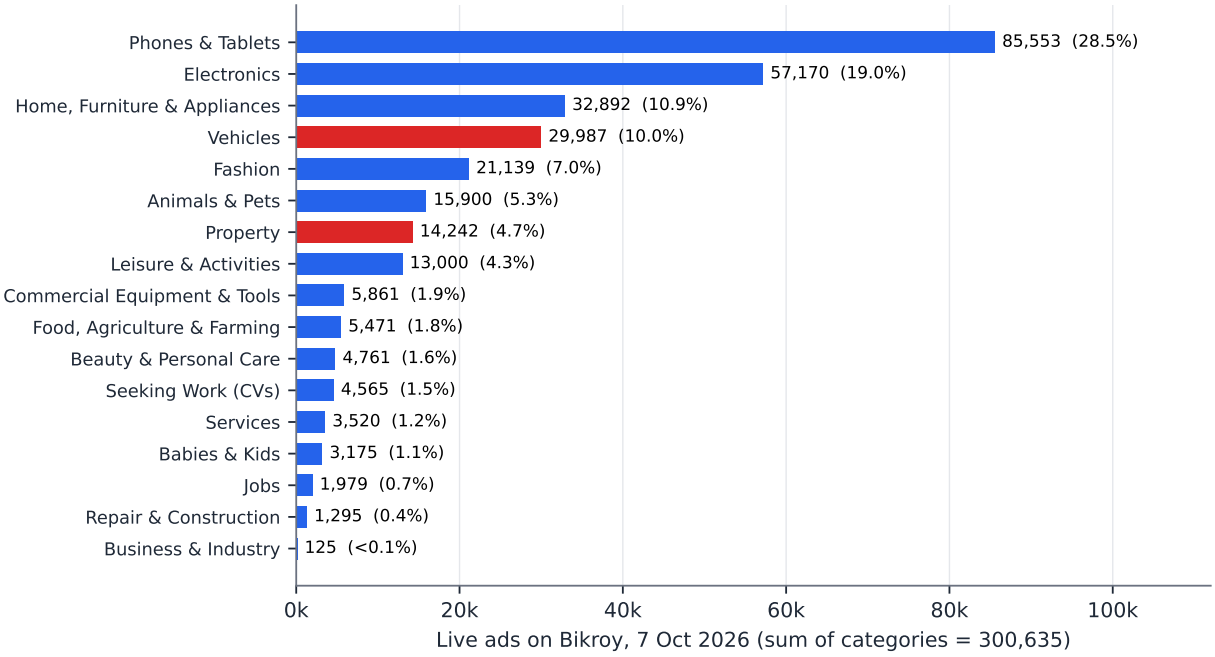


Figure 6: Live ads on Bikroy by top-level category, 7 October 2026. Red: the two high-value categories (vehicles and property); blue: all others. Percentages are shares of the sum of categories. Source: Bikroy category pages [40].

And they are mostly second-hand. The condition filters show that Bikroy is still overwhelmingly a market for used goods (Figure 7). Of 75,392 mobile-phone ads, 68,360 (91%) are for used phones, 1,528 (2%) refurbished and 5,303 (7%) new. Of 20,717 laptop and computer ads, 18,308 (88%) are used, 257 (1%) refurbished and 2,130 (10%) new [40]. In 2017 Bikroy's marketing director said that about a quarter of goods traded on the site were new items sold by small retailers [41]; that figure measured trades rather than listings, so it is not directly comparable, but both point the same way: most of what changes hands on Bikroy is second-hand.

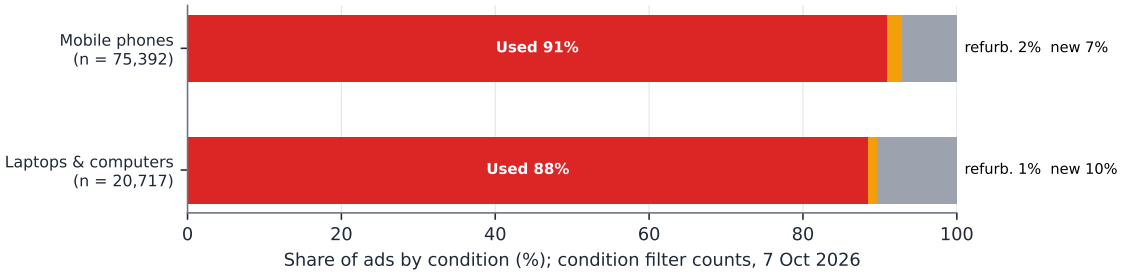


Figure 7: Share of ads by condition in Bikroy's two largest everyday-goods subcategories, 7 October 2026. Source: Bikroy condition filters [40].

Listings versus value. These counts do not contradict the report at the time of the sale that Bikroy's $3 billion annual GMV is concentrated in vehicles and real estate [9]. A single flat or car is worth as much as hundreds of used phones, so the two high-value categories can dominate the money while everyday goods dominate the ads. Bikroy therefore still sells old goods in large numbers: by number of listings it is mainly a second-hand phone, electronics and household-goods market, while by value it is mainly a car and property market. The person-to-person resale of used goods, where the scams documented in Section 3 occur, is the largest part of its catalogue.

Digital goods. Bikroy's video-games subcategory held 288 ads in the same snapshot, including game-account sales such as Free Fire and eFootball IDs priced at BDT 7,000 to 32,500 [40]. This trade is discussed in Section 5.2.

How many people use Bikroy. Bikroy does not publish a yearly traffic series, so visitor numbers over time have to be pieced together from occasional company statements and third-party estimates. The company figures use the same measure, monthly unique visitors or users, and are shown in Figure 8: more than 2 million in September 2014 [3], around 2 million in March 2017 [41], and about 3 million at the time of the sale in May 2026 [9]. Taken at face value, the audience grew by roughly half over twelve years, and was essentially flat between 2014 and 2017.

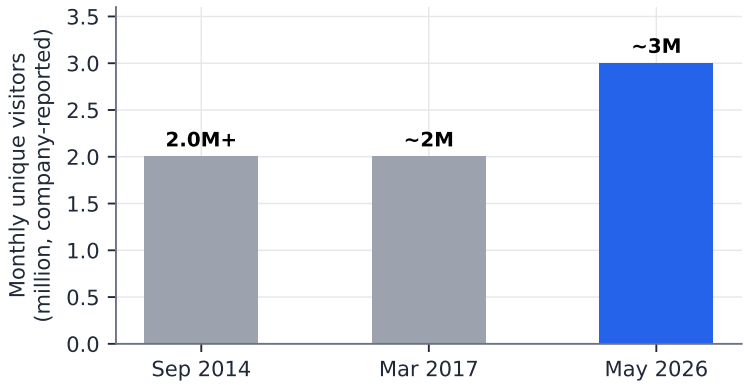


Figure 8: Bikroy's monthly audience as reported by the company at three points in time. Sources: [3, 41, 9].

Third-party estimates measure total visits rather than unique visitors, and they disagree sharply with each other (Table 3). Semrush's two estimates eight months apart differ by a factor of about nine, which reflects changes in estimation rather than a real ninefold jump. These figures are therefore used in this report only for direction of change over short periods (Figure 5), not for the size of Bikroy's audience.

Table 3: Third-party traffic estimates for bikroy.com. Estimates from different providers, or from the same provider at different times, are not directly comparable.

Provider	Period	Estimate
Semrush	Dec 2025	1.35 million visits, down 18.93% on the previous month [14]
Semrush	Aug 2026	12.4 million visits [13]
Similarweb	Jul–Sep 2026	3.3 million visits over three months (about 1.1 million a month); down 12.78% in September [12]

2.5 Owner retreat and sale (2022–2026)

The clearest sign of decline is not in Bikroy's own numbers but in its owner's behaviour (Figure 9). Saltside sold its Ghanaian platform, Tonaton, to Jiji in 2022. By September 2024, Saltside's group-level headcount had fallen to 13 people. In January 2025, Kinnevik, Saltside's largest shareholder with a 45% stake, publicly announced it wanted to sell that stake [9]. Two months later, in March 2025, the Nigerian classifieds company Jiji entered Bangladesh through `jiji-bd.com` as a direct competitor to Bikroy, Daraz and Ajkerdeal [10]. Thirteen months after that, in May 2026, Jiji acquired Bikroy [11, 10].

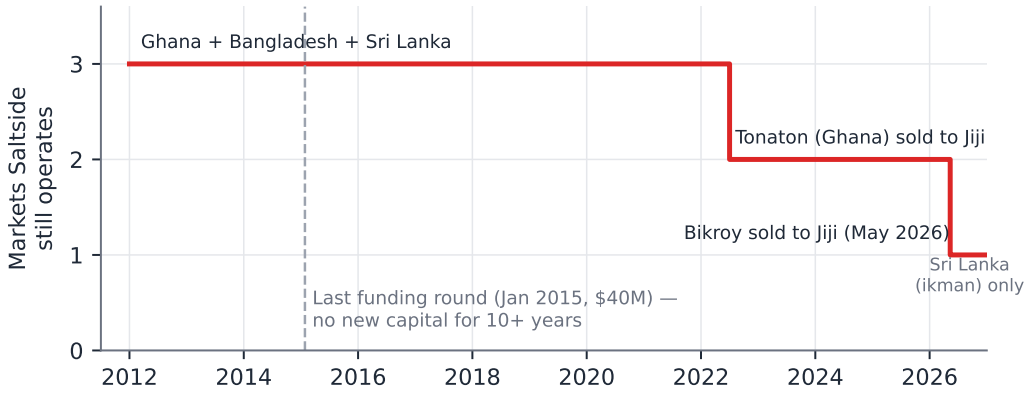


Figure 9: Number of markets in which Saltside Technologies still operates a classifieds platform. After its last funding round in January 2015, it sold Ghana (2022) and Bangladesh (2026), both to Jiji. Source: Future Startup [9].

Under Jiji, the Bikroy brand will survive, but the platform is being moved onto Jiji's technology and its monetisation is changing from Bikroy's flat-fee model to a pay-per-click bidding system in which sellers bid for placement [9]. Future Startup observes that this changes the economics for small sellers significantly, because it favours sellers with larger budgets and the skill to optimise bids [9]. After the acquisition, Jiji's main competition in Bangladesh is Facebook Marketplace and social-media sellers [9].

2.6 Causes of decline

Bikroy is still a large, functioning business, so "downfall" here means a loss of momentum, market position and independence rather than a collapse. The evidence above points to six connected causes.

1. **The trust problem was managed, never solved.** Bikroy's own 2014 audit found that one ad in three was not genuine [4]. Its main response, SMS-OTP verification in 2017 [6], only proves control of a phone number, and police later broke up a gang that bought registered SIM cards for 350–500 taka each to post fake electronics ads on Bikroy [16]. In 2026, Bikroy's listing pages still tell users to avoid advance payment, meet in a public place and pay only after inspection [20]; the responsibility for safety remains with the user.
2. **It never controlled the transaction.** Bikroy connects buyers and sellers but, outside its "Buy Now" cash-on-delivery service, payment and handover happen off-platform. A platform that does not hold the money cannot protect either party, and cash meetings expose both sides to fraud, as in the 2023 case where a gang paid an iPhone seller who had advertised on Bikroy with a bundle of mostly 20-taka notes disguised as 1,000-taka notes [17].
3. **It won by default, not by innovation.** Bikroy's dominance came after well-funded rivals exited [5], and Future Startup notes it "didn't face much sustained competition" [9]. Without competitive pressure, the core model (a listing board) stayed essentially the same for over a decade.
4. **Its owner stopped investing.** Saltside raised no new capital after January 2015, shrank its headquarters to 13 people, sold Ghana, and saw its largest shareholder seek an exit [9]. A platform whose owner is looking for the door does not make bold new bets on trust infrastructure.
5. **Its audience is being absorbed by social media.** In an interview with Future Startup, Bikroy's marketing director called Facebook the biggest challenge for every online site in Bangladesh [7]. Today Jiji itself names Facebook Marketplace and social-media sellers as Bikroy's main competition [9], and third-party traffic estimates show Bikroy losing rank (Figures 4 and 5).
6. **Small individual sellers are being priced toward the margins.** The switch to pay-per-click bidding favours businesses with marketing budgets [9], and sellers already complain that paid promotion produces fake inquiries rather than buyers [15]. Most of Bikroy's transaction value is in cars and property [9], yet most of its ads are everyday used goods posted by individuals (Section 2.4). The pricing change falls hardest on exactly the sellers who make up the bulk of its catalogue.

Implication for TrustBazaar. Bikroy has not been "replaced" because every challenger (OLX, Ekhanei and Jiji) competed with the same model: a listing board where payment and delivery happen elsewhere. None competed on the transaction itself. The gap that remains, verified identity, money held until delivery, fair price discovery and coordinated delivery for individual-to-individual resale, is exactly the space TrustBazaar targets. TrustBazaar does not need to out-list Bikroy; it needs to make the transactions that Bikroy leaves to chance safe.

3 Users' Experience and Fraud on Bikroy.com

Section 2 showed that Bikroy remains large but has never solved its trust problem. This section examines what buyers and sellers actually experience on Bikroy, whether people are still being scammed, and where exactly in a transaction the platform leaves them exposed. We separate two things that are often confused: how users rate the *app* as a tool, and how safe a *transaction* made through it is.

3.1 What users say

The app itself is well liked. It would be misleading to claim users hate Bikroy. On Google Play, the Bikroy app has a 4.3-star average from about 210,000 reviews and more than 10 million

downloads (Figure 10) [22]. People value it as a fast way to post an ad and reach buyers. The most visible recent reviews (May–September 2026) complain mainly about usability after the switch to Jiji's platform: users report that the redesigned interface is harder to navigate and that the filter separating member (business) ads from individual sellers was removed, making person-to-person deals and price comparison harder [22].

Sellers who pay are less satisfied. On Trustpilot, Bikroy scores 2.0 out of 5 from 13 reviews [15]. One seller advised others never to pay for ads, suspecting that paid promotions trigger automated messages that only look like buyer interest; the same reviewer objected to manual review and requests for private information on a flat-rental ad [15]. Thirteen reviews is far too few to represent all users, so we treat these as illustrative complaints rather than a measurement.

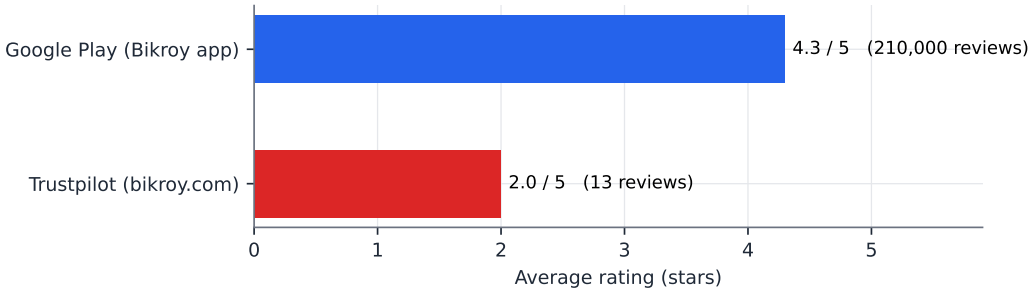


Figure 10: Bikroy's ratings on two review platforms, as of October 2026. The very different sample sizes mean the two numbers measure different things: app usability for a large general audience versus experiences of a small, self-selected group. Sources: [22, 15].

Why ratings do not measure safety. A high app rating and a high scam risk can coexist. App-store reviews are written mostly by people for whom the app worked; a buyer who loses money to a fake seller blames the seller or the police process, not the app's interface. National data show how rarely fraud victims take formal action at all: in a 2023–24 survey of 132 cybercrime victims by the Cyber Crime Awareness Foundation (CCAF), 40.15% had suffered financial loss, but only 12% pursued legal action (Figure 11) [23]. Most fraud, in other words, is never recorded anywhere a researcher can find it.

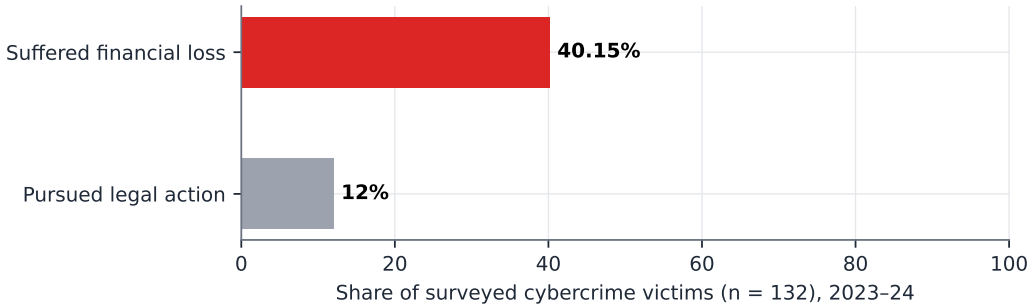


Figure 11: Financial loss versus legal action among 132 surveyed cybercrime victims in Bangladesh (survey period April 2023 – April 2024). Source: CCAF [23].

3.2 Documented scams and how they work

Police and newspaper reports describe a small number of recurring scam patterns on Bikroy. Table 4 classifies them by who is harmed and at which stage of the transaction.

Table 4: Scam patterns documented on Bikroy.com.

Pattern	Victim	Stage	Evidence
Fake seller, advance payment	Buyer	Payment	Muktagacha gang posted cheap phone and electronics ads from accounts opened with SIM cards bought for Tk 350–500; took lakhs of taka [16]. Fake sellers typically underprice items [4].
Lure and robbery	Buyer	Handover	In 2014 Bikroy itself reported fake sellers luring buyers to remote places and robbing them [4].
Fake buyer, counterfeit or swapped cash	Seller	Payment and handover	2023: gang paid an iPhone seller with a bundle of mostly Tk 20 notes; active for more than three years; three arrested [17].
Fake or replica goods	Buyer	Listing	Widespread allegations by 2017 led Bikroy to ban replica and clone items [6].
Fake inquiries after paid promotion	Seller	Listing	Seller complaint that paid ads attract automated, non-genuine messages [15] (unverified, single review).

Two of these patterns are traced step by step below. Figure 12 shows the fake-seller scam as reconstructed from the Muktagacha case and Bikroy's own 2014 account. Each check Bikroy runs (phone verification and ad review) happens *before* the scam starts; once buyer and seller are talking directly, the money moves entirely outside the platform, and afterwards Bikroy's terms state that it is not a party to the transaction [18].

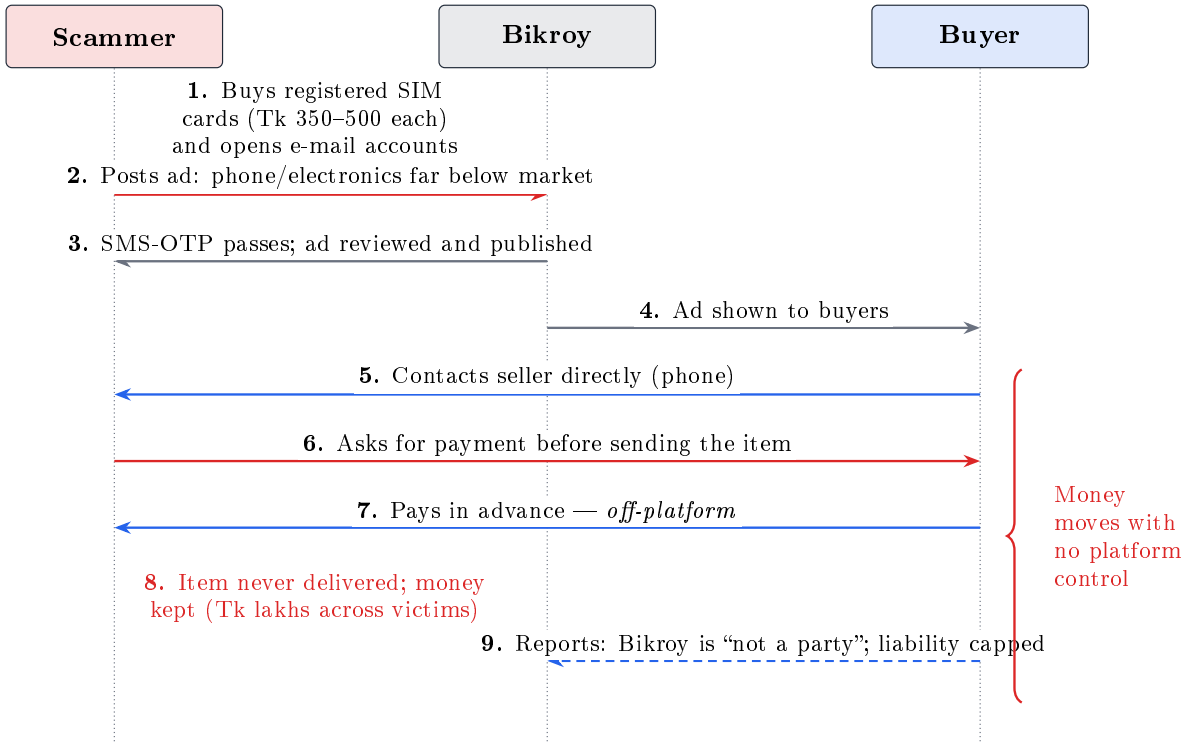


Figure 12: Typical fake-seller (advance-payment) scam on a classifieds platform, compiled from the Muktagacha case [16], Bikroy's 2014 statement [4] and Bikroy's current terms [18]. Steps 3–4 are the only points at which the platform is involved.

Figure 13 shows the reverse case, where the *seller* is the victim. This scam does not need a fake listing at all: it exploits the cash meeting that Bikroy's own safety advice recommends (meet in person, inspect, then pay) [19].

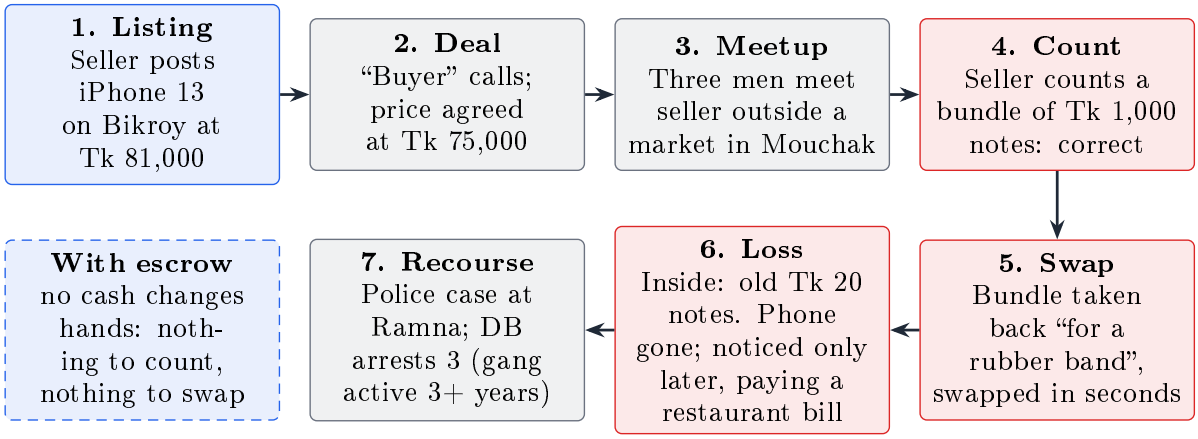


Figure 13: The 2023 note-swap scam against a seller who listed an iPhone 13 on Bikroy, reconstructed from Prothom Alo's report of the Detective Branch case [17]. The dashed box shows what an escrow payment would remove.

3.3 Where Bikroy's protection stops

Putting the cases together gives a clear picture (Figure 14). A used-goods deal passes through six stages. Bikroy has weak control over the first three (identity, listing, contact) and none over the last three (payment, handover, dispute). The most damaging documented scams (fake sellers, robbery and counterfeit cash) strike in the three stages Bikroy does not control, while fake identities and replica goods pass through the weak checks at the start.

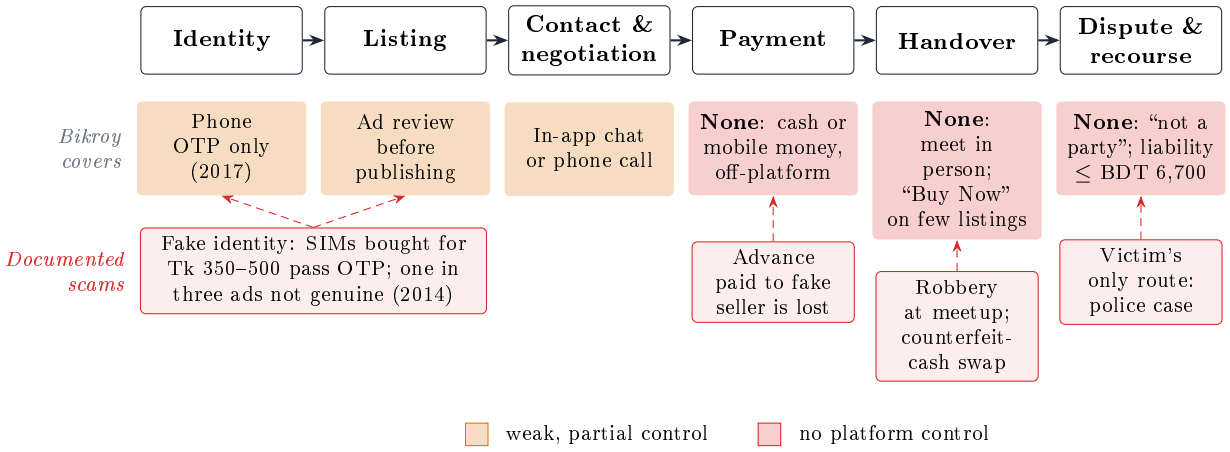


Figure 14: Bikroy's control over each stage of a used-goods transaction (orange: weak or partial; red: none), and where the documented scams in Table 4 strike. Sources: [6, 11, 18, 19, 16, 4, 17].

3.4 Are people still being scammed in 2026?

We should be precise about what the evidence shows.

- **Bikroy-named cases.** The police cases we found that explicitly name Bikroy run up to 2023 [17, 16]. We did not find a 2025–26 news report that names Bikroy, but newspapers often describe the platform only as "online", so this is absence of reporting, not evidence that the scams stopped.
- **The platform's own position.** In 2026 every Bikroy listing still carries warnings to avoid advance payment and to meet in a public place [20], and its terms still disclaim responsibility for losses between users [18]. The conditions that made these scams possible are unchanged.

- **The same pattern elsewhere.** Advance-payment fraud through online ads is still being prosecuted in 2026: in August 2026, police in Narail arrested members of a gang that took money through online ads for hilsa fish and recovered phones, SIM cards and Tk 60,000 [24].

3.5 The national lesson: escrow already works

Advance-payment fraud is not unique to Bikroy; it is one of the defining failures of Bangladeshi online commerce. Evaly, which sold goods at half price against advance payment and then failed to deliver, owed about Tk 543 crore to customers and suppliers; its founders were sentenced in January 2025 [25]. A similar case against e-Orange was still in court in February 2026 [26].

The government's response was escrow. On 30 June 2021 Bangladesh Bank issued a circular requiring payment gateways to hold customers' advance payments and release them to the merchant only after the product is delivered and the delivery documents are verified [27]. The effect was measurable (Figure 15): of Tk 5.05 billion that customers paid through gateways from 14 October 2021, Tk 2.14 billion was still being held when the failed platforms collapsed, and in October 2021 the government decided to return it to customers who had not received their goods [28].

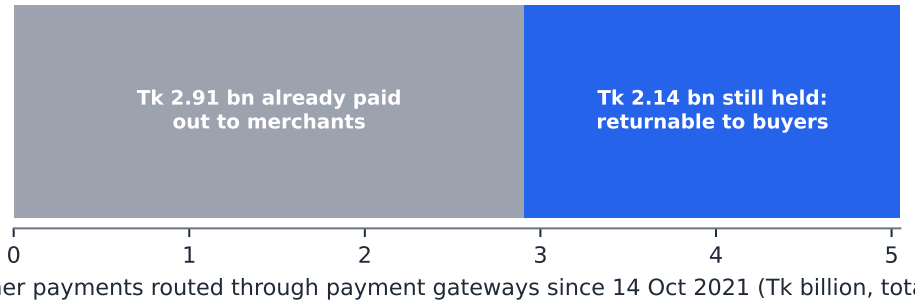


Figure 15: Customer payments routed through payment gateways under the 2021 escrow system, split into money already released to merchants and money still held, which could be returned to buyers. Source: The Financial Express [28].

This regime protects buyers of *business* e-commerce sites. It does not reach person-to-person deals arranged through classifieds, because on Bikroy the payment never passes through the platform or a gateway at all: buyer and seller settle in cash or by direct transfer [18]. The protection Bangladesh already decided online buyers need therefore stops exactly where individual resale begins.

3.6 Summary: the loopholes

The evidence in Sections 2 and 3 identifies six loopholes, which Section 4 maps to TrustBazaar's features.

L1. Weak identity. A phone number is the only identity check, and registered SIM cards can be bought for Tk 350–500 [6, 16].

L2. No payment protection. Money moves off-platform with no holding point [18, 19].

L3. Unsafe handover. Buyers and sellers must meet with cash, which enables robbery and counterfeit-cash swaps [4, 17].

L4. No recourse. Bikroy is not a party to the deal, caps its liability at BDT 6,700 and offers no dispute process [18].

L5. No accountability record. There is no verified transaction history, so a scammer can return under a new number, and Bikroy has published no fraud measurement since 2014 [4].

L6. No fair price discovery. Bikroy offers fixed prices and informal negotiation only; there is no auction format with enforced rules.

4 How TrustBazaar Closes Bikroy's Loopholes

Sections 2 and 3 showed that Bikroy's weakness is not its app, which users rate 4.3 out of 5 [22], but the *transaction*: Bikroy controls who may post an ad, but not the money, the handover or the dispute, and its terms say so [18]. This section takes the six loopholes identified in Section 3.6 and shows, one by one, which TrustBazaar feature closes each and how. It then replays the documented scams against TrustBazaar's design, and ends with a direct answer to the question of why anyone would use it. All TrustBazaar features cited here are specified in our project proposal [21].

4.1 Loophole-to-feature mapping

Table 5 pairs each loophole with the feature that closes it, and Figure 16 shows the full picture: which features act as the primary fix for each loophole and which support it. Escrow settlement alone is the primary fix for three of the six loopholes (L2, L3 and L4), which is why the proposal treats it as part of the critical path [21].

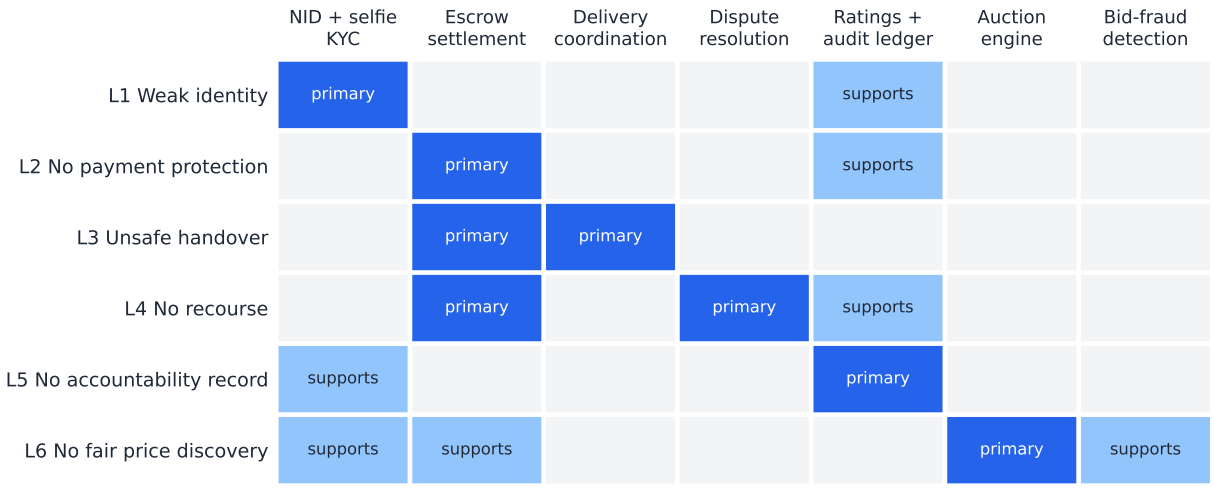


Figure 16: Which TrustBazaar feature addresses which Bikroy loophole. Dark cells: the feature is the primary fix; light cells: it supports the fix. Escrow settlement is the primary fix for three loopholes. Mapping derived from the TrustBazaar proposal [21].

4.2 Same transaction, different control

Figure 14 traced a used-goods deal through six stages and showed that Bikroy has no control over the last three. Figure 17 draws the same six stages for TrustBazaar. The difference is concentrated in the stages where the documented scams happen: payment, handover and dispute.

Table 5: Each Bikroy loophole (Section 3.6) and the TrustBazaar feature that closes it. Objective (Obj.) and acceptance-criterion numbers refer to the project proposal [21]; requirement identifiers (FR-KYC, FR-AUC) refer to version 2.0 of the project's SRS.

Loophole on Bikroy	**TrustBazaar feature**	**How it closes the gap**
L1 Weak identity: phone OTP only; SIM cards cost Tk 350–500 [6, 16]	NID + selfie KYC before listing or buying (Obj. 1; FR-KYC-01–FR-KYC-11), with an AI pre-check of document quality and selfie match	The account is tied to a verified national identity, not a SIM card. A banned person cannot return by buying a new number.
L2 No payment protection: money moves off-platform [18, 19]	Escrow settlement through bKash, Nagad or card (Obj. 3)	The buyer pays into escrow; the seller is paid only after the buyer confirms receipt, or automatically after a fixed timeout. This is the principle Bangladesh Bank mandated for e-commerce in 2021 [27].
L3 Unsafe handover: cash meetings enable robbery and note swaps [4, 17]	System-arranged delivery (Obj. 4): a suggested safe public meetup point, or a courier at a system-quoted fare	No cash changes hands at the meeting, because payment is already in escrow. With nothing to count, there is nothing to swap.
L4 No recourse: Bikroy is not a party; liability capped at BDT 6,700 [18]	Dispute resolution by a platform operator while funds are still held	The dispute is raised before the money leaves escrow, so a refund is actually possible. Under the 2021 regime, Tk 2.14 bn still held in escrow could be returned to buyers [28].
L5 No accountability record: no verified history; no fraud data since 2014 [4]	Ratings tied to completed transactions, and an auditable ledger of payment splits (Obj. 5)	Only someone who completed an escrow deal can leave a review, so reviews cannot be faked. Every payment split is recorded and inspectable in a dispute.
L6 No fair price discovery: fixed prices and informal haggling only	Server-authoritative auction with proxy bids, reserve price, anti-sniping extension (Obj. 2; FR-AUC-01–FR-AUC-18) and bid-fraud detection	The server, not the client, decides the end time and the winner; a late bid extends the auction; suspicious bidding is flagged to the operator.

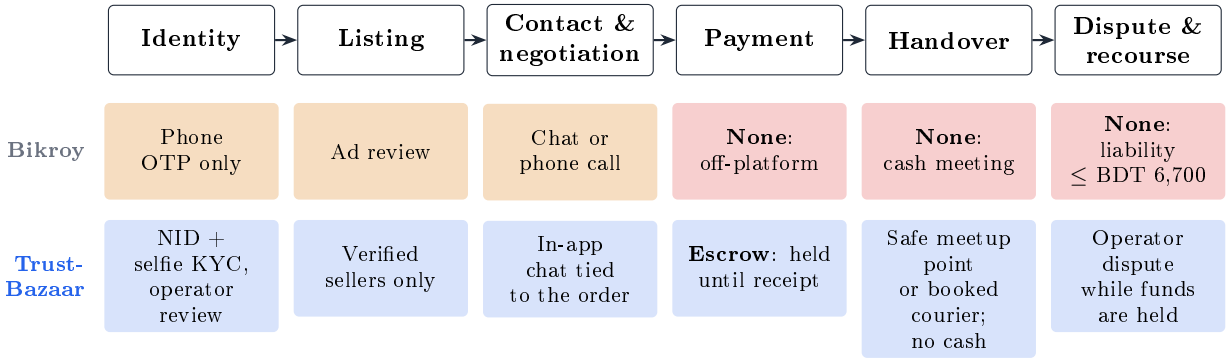
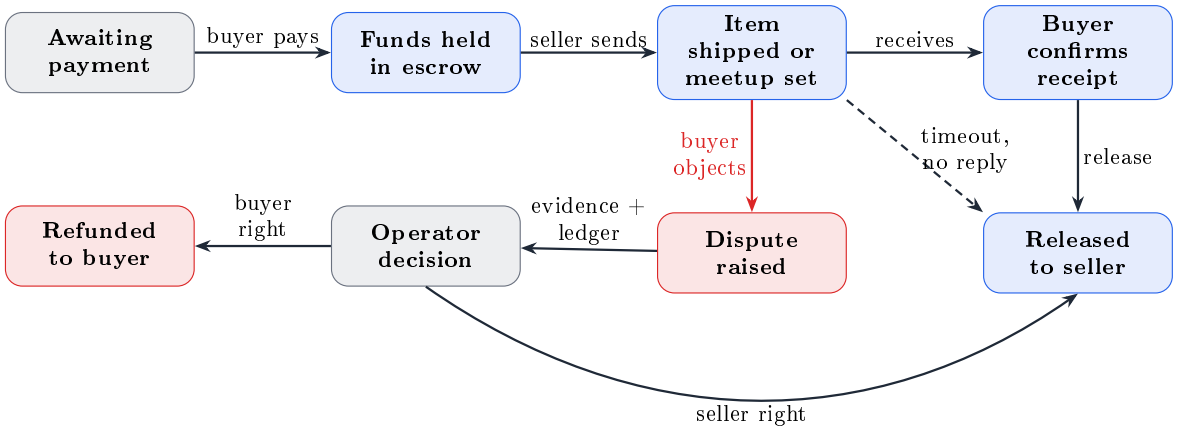


Figure 17: The six stages of a used-goods transaction, comparing Bikroy's control (top row, from Figure 14) with TrustBazaar's design (bottom row). Sources: Bikroy [6, 11, 18]; TrustBazaar [21].

The core of this design is the escrow state machine in Figure 18. It implements the proposal's third acceptance criterion: an escrow payment is never released to a seller without either the buyer's explicit confirmation or a genuine timeout. It also implements the fourth: a payment notice (webhook) that the provider delivers twice is never processed twice [21]. Because the money is still held when a dispute is raised, a refund is a database operation, not a police case.



Money leaves escrow only after the buyer confirms, after the timeout expires, or by an operator decision; never on the seller's word alone. A payment notice that the provider sends twice is processed only once.

Figure 18: TrustBazaar's escrow settlement as a state machine. Money can leave escrow by only three routes: buyer confirmation, an expired timeout, or an operator's dispute decision. Based on Objective 3 and Acceptance criteria 3–4 of the proposal [21].

4.3 Replaying the documented scams

Table 6 takes each scam pattern documented in Section 3 (Table 4) and shows where TrustBazaar's design stops it.

Table 6: The scam patterns documented on Bikroy, replayed against TrustBazaar's design.

Documented scam	What happens on TrustBazaar
Fake seller, advance payment (Muktagacha) [16]	Each SIM-bought account would still need a real NID and selfie to list, blocking the scam at the start. Even if a fake listing slipped through, the buyer's money sits in escrow, so non-delivery leads to a refund instead of a loss.
Lure and robbery (2014) [4]	The system suggests a public meetup point, or the buyer uses a courier and never meets the seller. Both parties' verified identities are on record.
Counterfeit or swapped cash (2023 iPhone case) [17]	No cash at the meeting: payment is already held in escrow.
Fake or replica goods [6]	The buyer inspects the item and can raise a dispute before any money is released.
Fake inquiries after paid promotion [15]	TrustBazaar's revenue is a commission on *completed* sales [21], not a charge per click. The platform earns only when a real deal happens, unlike the pay-per-click model Bikroy is moving to under Jiji [9].

4.4 Market position: what TrustBazaar offers that incumbents do not

The mapping above implies five points about where TrustBazaar sits in the market.

1. **It targets a slice of the market, not the whole of it.** Most of Bikroy's transaction value is in cars and property [9], but most of its ads are used phones, electronics and household goods (Section 2.4). TrustBazaar is designed for that individual-to-individual resale of used goods [21], the part of the market where the documented scams cluster [16, 17] and where a buyer has no way to verify a stranger.
2. **It differs in kind from every previous challenger.** OLX, Ekhanei and Jiji all ran listing boards [5, 10]. None of them competed on the transaction itself. TrustBazaar is a different kind of product: a settlement platform, not a classifieds board.
3. **It applies a protection Bangladesh has already adopted.** After the Evaly failures, the state required escrow for e-commerce payments [27], and money still held in escrow was returned to buyers [28]. That regime never reached person-to-person resale (Section 3). TrustBazaar applies a protection the state has already validated to the part of the market it misses.
4. **It suits the individual sellers Bikroy is moving away from.** Under Jiji, pay-per-click bidding favours sellers with marketing budgets [9]. A fee charged only on completed deals better suits someone selling one used phone.
5. **It offers what Facebook groups do not.** They have no verification, no payment handling and no record of who committed to buy [21]. For a buyer about to send a large sum to a stranger, TrustBazaar's offer is simple: the money does not move until the buyer has the item.

4.5 Limits and risks

The design does not remove every barrier to adoption. Table 7 lists the main risks and how TrustBazaar's design responds to each.

Table 7: Main risks to TrustBazaar's adoption and the design response.

Risk	Why it is real	Design response
Network effect	Bikroy has about 400,000 monthly buyers and 100,000 monthly sellers [9]; a new platform starts with none.	This is the main open risk and is not solved by design alone. The project's aim is to demonstrate that the trust mechanisms work correctly, not to reach market scale [21].
KYC friction	Users already complain about Bikroy's manual checks [15].	KYC is done once, not per ad. It gives the user something back (escrow protection and a verified badge) rather than being a cost with no return.
Seller cash-flow delay	Escrow holds the money until the buyer confirms.	An automatic release timeout means a silent buyer cannot hold the funds indefinitely [21].
Regulation	Holding customers' money requires a licensed payment partner.	The academic build uses sandbox and test-mode integrations, stated openly [21]. A real launch would route funds through a licensed gateway's escrow service, the model the 2021 Bangladesh Bank rule uses [27].
Fees	Buyers and sellers may resist paying a commission.	The fee is charged only on a successful, protected deal, set against the documented cost of being scammed.

4.6 Summary

Bikroy has led the market since 2012 without being challenged on what it does not do. It is a listing board that leaves payment, handover and disputes to chance, and its own terms say so [18]. TrustBazaar does not compete on the number of ads. It closes the six loopholes that Bikroy, Facebook groups and the 2021 escrow rule all leave open for individual resale. Its value proposition is therefore not scale but safety: it is designed to protect exactly the deals that Bikroy's terms decline responsibility for.

5 The Competitive Landscape: Why No Existing Platform Fills the Gap

Sections 2–4 compared TrustBazaar with Bikroy. Bikroy is not the only option, however: Facebook and Daraz also carry resale and online sales. This section compares TrustBazaar with every realistic alternative available to a Bangladeshi reselling a used item today, including digital items such as game accounts and event tickets, and shows that the combination TrustBazaar offers does not exist in the market.

5.1 Bikroy under Jiji

Since May 2026 Bikroy runs on Jiji's platform [9]. Jiji's safety model is the same as Bikroy's: it moderates ads before publication, uses automated fraud detection, and instructs buyers never to pay before receiving an item, but it does not hold the payment itself [29]. The acquisition gave Bikroy a new owner, not a new trust model.

5.2 Facebook Marketplace and buy-and-sell groups

Facebook Marketplace has launched in Bangladesh, but Facebook does not facilitate payment or delivery for person-to-person Marketplace sales, and as of 2021 its Shops checkout was not available in Bangladesh [30]. Buyers and sellers therefore settle outside the platform, exactly as on Bikroy.

Scams on Facebook follow the same advance-payment pattern documented in Section 3. In February 2021, Dhaka police arrested five members of a gang that advertised goods on a Facebook page, took 50% advance payments plus delivery charges, and then shut down both the page and

the mobile-banking account. The gang had been operating for about six months and had opened its accounts using *fake national identity documents*, which made it hard to trace [31]. This last detail matters for TrustBazaar and is discussed in Section 5.6.

Digital goods: game accounts, tickets and the "admin deal"

Facebook buy-and-sell groups are also used to trade *digital* goods: accounts for games such as PUBG Mobile, Free Fire and Clash of Clans, Steam or Epic Games accounts, and event tickets. These items cannot be inspected like a phone. In the groups our team is familiar with, the usual way to manage the risk is an "admin deal", in which the group's admin acts as a middleman: the buyer sends the money to the admin, the seller sends the account ID and password to the admin, and the admin passes each on (Figure 19). We did not find a published study measuring how often these deals fail, but the available evidence shows why the structure itself is unsafe.

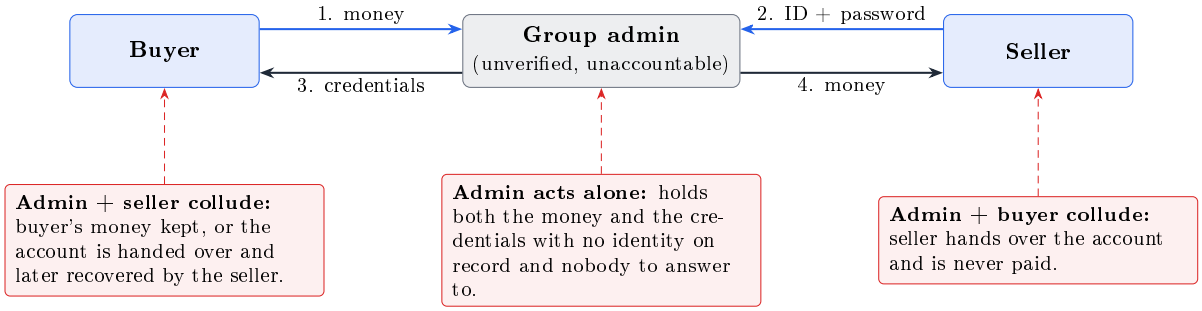


Figure 19: The Facebook-group "admin deal" for digital goods. A single unverified person holds both the money and the credentials, which allows three kinds of fraud. Risks of account transfer as described by Supercell [33]; admin misconduct illustrated by the 2026 BCEC case [32].

- **Admins hold power without accountability.** In July 2026 the Criminal Investigation Department (CID) arrested the 21-year-old admin of the Facebook group "Bangladesh Concert & Event Connects". He had approved posts selling tickets for an Atif Aslam concert that used images of tickets from a previously cancelled concert, and when the organisers asked him to remove them, he demanded Tk 1 lakh instead. A case was filed under the Cyber Security Act at Paltan Police Station [32]. The person members trusted to keep the group safe was the one exploiting it.
- **The game companies themselves name the risks.** Supercell's policy lists the dangers of buying an account: the seller may never deliver it, the same account may be sold to several buyers, and the original owner may keep access and take it back. Supercell also permanently bans accounts confirmed to have changed hands [33].
- **Account sales break the publishers' terms.** Steam's Subscriber Agreement forbids sharing a password or letting others use an account, and does not allow accounts to be sold or transferred (Section 1.C) [34]. Garena's terms for Free Fire make accounts non-transferable and for personal use only (Section 6.2) [35]. A buyer can therefore lose a purchased account to a ban even if the seller is honest.
- **The same fraud appears in the region.** In September 2022 Pakistan's Federal Investigation Agency arrested suspects in Faisalabad for selling fake PUBG accounts; one complainant alone had lost about PKR 820,000 [36].
- **Bikroy offers no answer either.** Bikroy hosts game-account listings, for example a Free Fire account advertised for BDT 9,500 in 2020, but shows the same safety tips it uses for physical goods: meet in a safe public place and inspect the item before paying [37]. That advice cannot be followed for a password.

- **Large platforms have recognised the problem.** In July 2025 Steam introduced a seven-day trade-protection window during which item trades can be reversed, specifically to counter scams and compromised accounts [38]. The industry's own answer to digital-goods fraud is a holding period, the same principle as escrow.

Digital goods therefore combine every weakness identified in this report. There is nothing to inspect, identities are unverified, the money moves first, and the only safeguard is a single unaccountable middleman. The revised TrustBazaar proposal therefore adds a dedicated game-account escrow, in which ownership is verified before listing, credentials are encrypted so that only the buyer can read them, and payment is held through a protection period after takeover [42]. Because account trading conflicts with the publishers' terms, the proposal discloses that risk to buyers before payment rather than presenting these sales as approved by the publisher.

5.3 Daraz

Daraz does protect buyers. Since October 2025 it has offered a 14-day return window on applicable items, with free pickup or drop-off and refunds that include delivery charges [39]. However, Daraz is built for businesses selling new stock: according to our proposal's market review, its seller requirements are built around business registration rather than personal identity checks, and it offers no auction format [21]. It is not designed for one person selling one used item to another.

5.4 Side-by-side comparison

Table 8 and Figure 20 compare the four platforms on the capabilities this report has shown to matter.

Table 8: Capabilities of the main platforms available for resale in Bangladesh.

Capability	Bikroy / Jiji	Facebook	Daraz	TrustBazaar
Built for individuals' used goods	Yes	Yes	No: businesses, new stock [21]	Yes
Identity verification	Phone OTP [6]	Facebook account only; fake NIDs used [31]	Business registration [21]	NID + selfie KYC
Who holds the payment	Nobody [18, 29]	Nobody [30]	Platform checkout	Escrow until receipt
Refund if item is bad or missing	No; liability $\leq$ BDT 6,700 [18]	No	Yes, 14-day returns [39]	Yes, dispute while funds are held
Handover	Meet in person [19]	Arranged by users	Platform logistics [39]	Safe meetup point or booked courier
Dispute process	None [18]	Group admin at best [32]	Returns process	Operator decision using ledger
Fair auction	No	Informal comment bidding [21]	No [21]	Server-timed, anti-sniping
Digital goods	Listed with physical-goods advice [37]	Admin deals	Not examined	Game-account escrow [42]

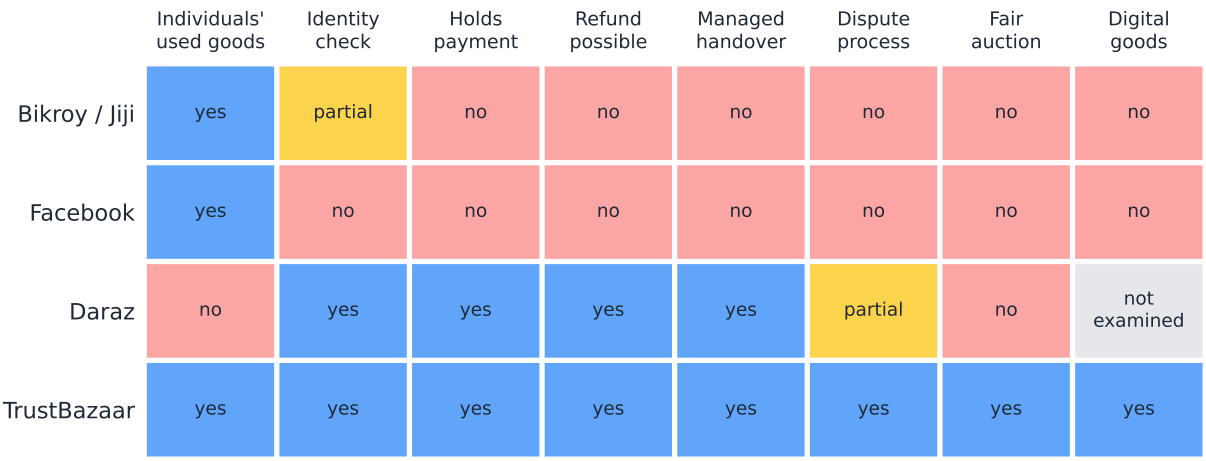


Figure 20: Capability matrix of Table 8. Blue: yes; yellow: partial; red: no; grey: not examined. Daraz's identity and auction entries come from our proposal's market review [21]; all other sources are given in Table 8.

5.5 The empty quadrant

Two questions separate the platforms: *who is it built for* (individuals selling used goods, or businesses selling new stock), and *does the platform protect the transaction* (hold the money, offer refunds, resolve disputes)? Bikroy and Facebook are built for individuals but protect nothing. Daraz protects the transaction but is built for businesses. No existing platform does both (Figure 21).

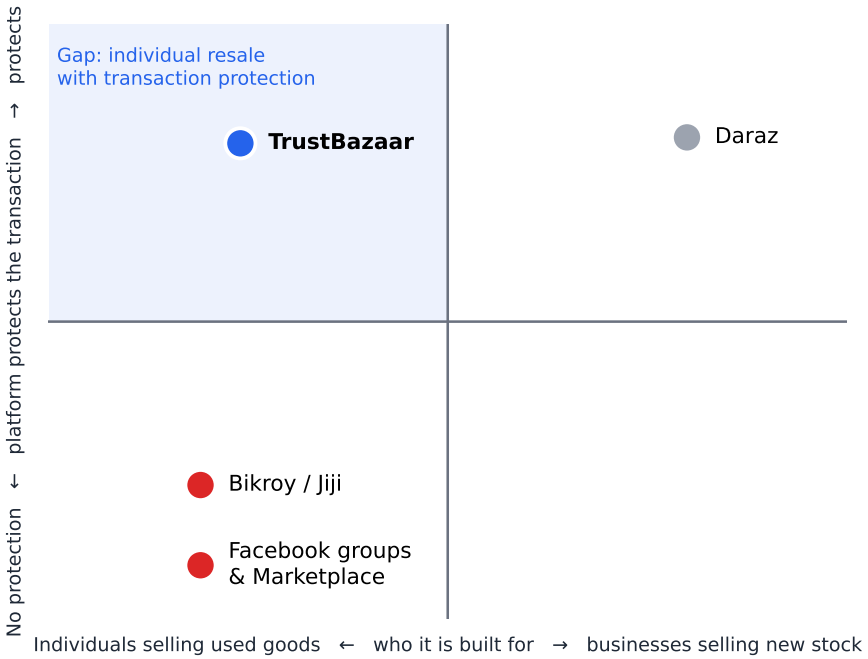


Figure 21: Qualitative positioning of the platforms, based on the capabilities in Table 8. Positions show which quadrant each platform belongs to, not a measured score.

Each existing platform proves half of TrustBazaar's case. Bikroy and Facebook prove the *demand*: hundreds of thousands of individuals resell used goods online every month [9]. Daraz and the 2021 escrow rule prove that the *protection* works and that Bangladeshi buyers accept platform-managed payments and returns [39, 27]. TrustBazaar combines the two.

5.6 Threats and honest limits

Table 9: Competitive threats and our assessment.

Threat	Assessment
Fake NIDs can defeat KYC, as the 2021 Facebook gang showed [31]	KYC raises the cost of fraud; it does not eliminate it. TrustBazaar adds a selfie match and operator review [21]. More importantly, escrow means a fake identity still cannot take the buyer's money: payment is released only when the buyer confirms receipt. Identity checks and escrow cover each other's gaps.
Daraz could open to individuals' used goods	Possible. If it did, that would confirm the gap is real; TrustBazaar's auction and person-to-person delivery design would still differ from Daraz's business model.
Jiji could add escrow to Bikroy	Also possible. So far Jiji's stated model is pay-on-delivery advice, not held payments [29].
Facebook's reach	Facebook's user base cannot be matched. TrustBazaar's case is not reach but the one thing Facebook does not offer for person-to-person deals in Bangladesh: holding the money [30].

TrustBazaar's advantage is its design, not a barrier competitors cannot copy. The project's aim is to show that this design can be built correctly, with concurrency-safe auctions and escrow that never releases money wrongly [21], not to claim that incumbents can never follow.

5.7 Summary

Every platform available to a Bangladeshi reseller today fails on at least one of two counts. Bikroy, Jiji and Facebook serve individuals but leave the transaction to chance, and for digital goods they leave it to an unaccountable group admin. Daraz protects the transaction but is not built for individuals reselling used goods. TrustBazaar is designed to combine both. Its case for adoption rests not on the other platforms being poor at what they do, but on none of them doing this.

6 Conclusions: Why Users Would Move to TrustBazaar

This section draws together the findings of Sections 2–5. Taken together, they show that Bikroy and Facebook Marketplace succeed at *connecting* buyers and sellers, but that neither protects the *transaction* that follows. Section 2 showed that this weakness has existed since Bikroy began; Section 3 showed where it harms users; Section 4 showed how TrustBazaar's design addresses each gap; and Section 5 showed that no other platform addresses them.

6.1 Key findings and their implications for adoption

Finding 1: Bikroy's trust problem was managed, never solved. Bikroy's own 2014 audit found that one ad in three was not genuine (Figure 3). Every measure it took afterwards cleaned up listings but neither protected a transaction nor helped a victim recover a loss (Table 1), and the audit was never repeated publicly. Users have therefore lived with the same risk for over a decade. TrustBazaar is designed to remove that risk rather than warn about it (Table 5).

Finding 2: Bikroy is losing position and changing in ways that disadvantage individual sellers. Bikroy fell from the 8th largest local website in 2014 to between #67 and #104 in 2026 (Figure 4), with month-on-month traffic declines (Figure 5). Its parent company stopped investing after 2015 and sold it to Jiji in 2026 (Figure 9, Section 2.5), and it is moving to pay-per-click pricing that favours sellers with marketing budgets (Section 2.6). TrustBazaar charges a commission only on completed deals (Table 6), a better fit for the individual seller Bikroy is moving away from.

Finding 3: users like the app but are not protected by it. The Bikroy app is well rated (Figure 10), but app ratings measure usability, not safety. Among surveyed cybercrime victims, 40% lost money and only 12% took legal action (Figure 11), so most fraud is never recorded. This explains how users can keep using Bikroy while remaining exposed. TrustBazaar does not require them to give up a familiar tool; it offers the protection that tool lacks.

Finding 4: every documented scam occurs where Bikroy has no control. The scam patterns in Table 4 strike at payment, handover and dispute, the three stages Bikroy does not control (Figure 14). Both the advance-payment scam (Figure 12) and the cash note-swap scam (Figure 13) depend on money changing hands outside the platform. Replayed against TrustBazaar, each pattern is stopped by escrow, verified identity or managed delivery (Table 6), and all six stages of a deal come under platform control (Figure 17).

Finding 5: escrow already works in Bangladesh, but not for person-to-person deals. Bangladesh Bank made escrow mandatory for e-commerce in 2021, and money still held in escrow could be returned to buyers (Figure 15). That rule never reached classifieds, because payment on Bikroy never passes through the platform (Section 3.5). TrustBazaar's escrow settlement (Figure 18) extends a protection the country has already adopted to the gap left open by loophole L2 (Section 3.6).

Finding 6: Facebook is no safer, and its group admins are a risk of their own. Facebook does not handle payment for person-to-person sales in Bangladesh, and scams there follow the same advance-payment pattern, including accounts opened with fake national IDs (Section 5.2). For digital goods, users rely on group admins who hold both the money and the credentials (Figure 19), a structure shown to be open to abuse by the 2026 arrest of a group admin. TrustBazaar replaces the trusted individual with a system that holds the money and records every decision (Table 5, loophole L5).

Finding 7: no existing platform combines individual resale with transaction protection. Bikroy and Facebook serve individuals but protect nothing; Daraz protects transactions but serves businesses selling new stock (Table 8, Figure 20). The quadrant for individual resale with transaction protection is empty (Figure 21). TrustBazaar is designed for that quadrant, and escrow alone is the primary fix for three of the six loopholes (Figure 16).

6.2 Summary of adoption drivers

Table 10 condenses these findings into the reasons a user would choose TrustBazaar, each linked to the evidence in this report.

6.3 Likely order of adoption

Comparing where the documented scams cluster (Table 4) with what TrustBazaar addresses (Table 5) suggests the order in which users are most likely to adopt it:

1. **Buyers of mid- and high-value used electronics.** The advance-payment and note-swap scams in Figures 12 and 13 involved phones and electronics, where losing the money is most costly.
2. **Individual sellers.** They are exposed to fake buyers (Figure 13) and to Bikroy's new pricing (Finding 2). Escrow protects them too: payment is secured before the item leaves their hands (Figure 18).
3. **Sellers seeking competitive bidding.** Neither Bikroy nor Facebook offers a fair auction (loophole L6, Table 8).

Table 10: Adoption drivers: what users face on existing platforms, where this report shows it, and what TrustBazaar offers instead.

What users face today	Shown in	What TrustBazaar offers
Payment goes straight to a stranger; no platform holds it	Fig. 14, Table 8	Escrow: seller paid only after the buyer confirms receipt
Robbery and counterfeit cash at meetups	Table 4, Fig. 13	No cash at the meeting; safe meetup point or booked courier
Identity is a phone number or a fake NID	Fig. 12, Sec. 5.2	NID + selfie KYC, backed by escrow
No refund or help after a scam	Table 1, Fig. 11	Dispute raised while the money is still held
Group admins hold money and passwords unchecked	Fig. 19	The system, not a person, holds the money; decisions logged
Pay-per-click pricing favours bigger sellers	Sec. 2.5, Sec. 2.6	Commission only on completed deals
No fair auction format	Table 8	Server-timed auction with anti-sniping

4. **Game-account buyers and sellers.** They currently depend on unaccountable group admins (Figure 19); the game-account escrow in the revised proposal [42] replaces that middleman, although publisher bans remain a risk the platform can disclose but not prevent (Section 5.2).

6.4 Limitations of this analysis

The conclusions above should be read within the following limits:

- **Incumbents retain scale.** Bikroy still reports about 400,000 monthly buyers (Section 2.3), and Facebook's reach cannot be matched (Table 9). Users will keep browsing there. The realistic shift is per transaction, not total: users are likely to move the risky step, paying a stranger, to where the money is protected (Tables 7 and 9).
- **Fraud is reduced, not eliminated.** KYC can be defeated by fake national IDs (Section 5.2); TrustBazaar's response is that escrow and identity checks cover each other's gaps (Table 9).
- **Evidence gaps.** The most recent police case naming Bikroy dates from 2023 (Section 3.4); traffic figures are third-party estimates (Table 2); the Trustpilot sample is small (Figure 10); and the description of admin deals rests on the authors' familiarity with these groups (Section 5.2).
- **No primary user data.** This analysis uses published sources only. A survey of buyers and sellers would be needed to measure demand directly.

6.5 Overall conclusion

Bikroy has led Bangladesh's online classifieds market since 2012, and no challenger has displaced it, because every challenger competed with the same model: a listing board that connects strangers and then steps away (Section 2.6). The evidence in this report shows that this model's weakness is structural. Bikroy controls who may post an ad, but not the money, the meeting or the dispute (Figure 14), and Facebook leaves the same gaps (Figure 20). A new platform therefore does not need more listings than Bikroy to attract users. It needs to be the place where a buyer's money does not move until the item arrives, and a seller's item does not leave until the money is secured

(Figure 18). On the evidence gathered here, no existing platform offers this for person-to-person resale in Bangladesh (Figure 21), and that is the basis on which TrustBazaar can persuade users to move.

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